

SEWANG

SEOUL · SINCE 1985

33

Guests Are Coming Back, and a Three-Day Holiday

For owners preparing the second half of August
Reading the next two weeks through search and field data

+29%

Izakaya searches

3 days

Aug 15–17 holiday

0 posts

mentioning the holiday

TO THE OWNER

The second half of August — three days decide it

One. Guests are already coming back. Izakaya searches hit a 15-week high, and solo drinking set a record alongside it.

Two. August 15 to 17 is a three-day holiday. Liberation Day falls on a Saturday, so Monday the 17th becomes a substitute holiday — the only holiday in August.

Three. Yet no one has prepared. Among 100 bar posts this week, the number mentioning the holiday was **not a single one**.

PART ONE

Guests Are Coming Back

15 weeks of Naver search volume · late April – early August
2026

Izakaya and solo drinking both at period highs

KEYWORD 01 IZAKAYA

Izakaya, a 15-week high

The first week of August set a new peak for the survey period.

Naver search volume · weekly · relative within group 2026.04-08

+29% vs. June low
first week of August



IN THE FIELD

This week's posts show izakaya conversation spreading to **Daejeon, Gyeongju, Ulsan, Daegu and Jeonju**. This is not a Seoul-only trend. Sashimi and sushi anchor the food, paired with highballs, draft beer and traditional liquor.

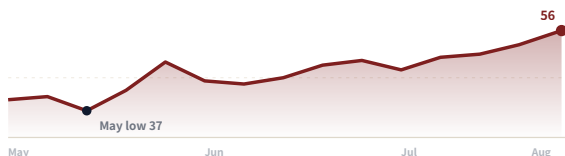
KEYWORD 02 HONSUL

Solo drinking, rising for 15 weeks

It has not dipped once.

Naver search volume · weekly · relative within group 2026.04-08

+51% vs. May low
first week of August



ALSO WORTH NOTING

Over the same period, non-alcoholic searches rose **+44%**. But this has not yet translated into venue orders. Rather than over-expanding, **keep just 1-2 items in stock** and watch the response — that is the safer path.

PART TWO

Three Days No One Has Prepared For

Saturday Aug 15 Liberation Day · Monday Aug 17 substitute holiday

The only holiday in August

02

HOLIDAY 01 CALENDAR

The real peak is Friday **the 14th**

Knowing tomorrow is a day off makes people stay for another round.

FRI	SAT	SUN	MON
14	15	16	17
Peak night	Liberation Day	Sunday	Substitute holiday

WHAT THIS HOLIDAY LOOKS LIKE

With Saturday through Monday linked, **nearby spending outweighs long trips**. Too short to travel far, too long to stay home — both neighbourhood districts and downtown areas stand to gain.

EASY TO MISS

Because Monday is a holiday, **Sunday-night guests will stay later than usual**. If you normally close early on Sundays, consider extending just for this week.

HOLIDAY 02 OBSERVATION

No One Has Prepared Yet

We reviewed all 100 bar posts published this week.

Posts mentioning the holiday collected 2026.08.10

O of 100 posts
Not a single one

Heat-related posts: 4

Remaining 96 — no holiday mention

WHICH MAKES IT AN OPENING

Venues are still focused on **cop**ing with the heat — extra air conditioning, summer tonics, cold dishes. The venue that puts out a holiday message **first, this week** will take those three days.

"Open as usual
August 15–17"

Whether you open over the holiday is what guests most want to know. One banner or one text message is enough.

HOLIDAY 03 ORDER

Order this week

This is the last delivery window before the holiday.

DEADLINE

Wednesday Aug 12 – Thursday Aug 13

Holiday order deadline. To have stock on hand for the Friday the 14th peak, orders must be placed by Thursday at the latest.

WHAT

WHAT TO INCREASE

The Friday peak moves **beer and soju**, while holiday daytime moves **highballs and lighter drinks**. This holiday is the last chance to clear summer stock — keep the September shift in mind and avoid over-ordering.

HOW WE CAN HELP

Holiday volumes and delivery schedules — **your account manager will plan them venue by venue**. If you are unsure about stock, just give us a call.

PART THREE

Venues Doing Well Right Now

Three movements standing out in the field this summer

03

MOVEMENT 01 SOLO BAR

Solo bars became a category

Venues are now putting "solo bar" right on the signage.

Openings by solo-bar brand
Yahwa

3 months since
launch

90 stores **in three months**
7 new sites in the capital area in July alone

WHERE THEY OPENED

Baegot, Guri Sutaek, Dasan, Wangsimni, Sindang, Gokbanjeong and Ajou University all opened within a month. **Compact units of roughly 26 m²** make rollout fast. Brands such as Damso, Jamanchu, Yusagil and Serenti are growing alongside.

WORTH WATCHING

What draws guests to these venues is not the drink but **the meeting**. They gather people with solo parties, matchmaking and social nights.

"Three years ago most people asked,
'What is a solo bar?'"

— a solo bar operator, writing online

MOVEMENT 02 COLLABORATION

They joined hands instead of competing

Jamsilsaenae — a beer hall and a solo bar run a cross promotion

JAMSILSAENAE · ~8/19

One district, two brands

In Jamsilsaenae, a joint promotion offering **cross benefits to each other's guests** runs until August 19. Rather than taking guests from each other, they are **drawing people into the district as a whole**.

IF YOU TRY THIS

You do not need to be a large brand. **Simply trading a coupon with the shop next door** keeps second-round guests inside the street. The more different the two formats, the better it works — a grill house and a bar, an izakaya and a pocha.

ESPECIALLY OVER THE HOLIDAY

A three-day holiday is when **people circulate street by street**. Agreeing with a neighbouring shop this week is enough to use it on the 15th to 17th.

MOVEMENT 03 SUBSTITUTE

"I meant to go to Japan but ended up in Ansan"

Izakayas are becoming a substitute for overseas travel.

CASE

Okki Ansan Jungang

63 Gojan 1-gil, Danwon-gu, Ansan, Gyeonggi

"More Japanese on the walls than Korean — the moment you walk in it feels like a trip"

— from a guest review

WHY IT WORKS NOW

Exchange rates and prices have made overseas travel a burden this summer. **Venues selling the feeling of travel without the airfare** are filling up. This does not mean gutting the interior — menu wording, music, or even the glassware alone can change the impression.

PAIRED WITH THE HOLIDAY

Over a three-day holiday, **guests who cannot travel far** seek out exactly this kind of venue. "Here instead of a trip" is message enough.

OBSERVATION STANDING PUB

Standing bars have split into two markets

We counted **29 standing pubs** across the country. Here is what we found.

Japanese beer track · 21 venues

KRW 7,900–11,900

Domestic beer track · 10 venues

KRW 3,800–6,000

Same format, yet **prices differ two to three times per glass**. This is not one trend but **two entirely different businesses**.

THE DOMESTIC TRACK SELLS CRAFT

These venues stake their name not on the brand but on **how the beer is poured**. One pours a single Cass four different ways (Mullae), one advertises a beer-master certification (Chungmuro), one manages even the thickness of the glass (Daegu).

THE DECISION POINT

Removing the chairs is not the point. **Tap cleaning, glass temperature and keg turnover** — without these, changing the format achieves nothing. Get all three right and a glass of draft is worth more with the menu you already have.

ACTION CHECKLIST

Five things before the holiday

To check today, Wednesday August 12

- ☐ **Holiday order** placed by Thursday
 - ☐ **Friday Aug 14 staffing** set heavier than usual
 - ☐ **"Open as usual over the holiday"** — posted where guests can see it
 - ☐ **Sunday closing time** pushed back for this week only
 - ☐ A seat where a guest arriving alone **does not feel out of place**
-

IF THREE OR FEWER

It is not too late. There are **four days** until the holiday — an order and one banner covers most of it.

CLOSING

Guests have returned, and three days remain

Izakaya and solo-drinking searches hit 15-week highs. A three-day holiday runs from August 15 to 17, and no one has prepared for it yet. The venue that moves first takes the last peak of this summer.

Sewang will help you prepare the second half of August — with data and with stock.

Data · Naver DataLab search trends (2026.04.27–08.09, weekly, relative within group) / Instagram hashtag observation (100 posts from #izakaya #newbar #solobar #hotbar and 75 from #standingbar #standingpub #tachinomi, collected 2026.08.10) / Field survey of 29 standing pubs (Naver Local and blogs, 2026.08.10) / Industry news review (2026.06–08).

Search figures are relative values within the period, not absolute counts, and are indicative of direction only.

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New account development

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